

News Weekly

Hand stencil made almost 68,000 years ago is the oldest cave art ever found

The world's oldest known cave art, estimated to be at least 67,800 years old, was recently discovered in Indonesia, specifically within the Liang Metanduno cave. This extraordinary artwork features reddish hand stencils, created by blowing pigment onto a hand pressed against the rock surface. These stencils are thought to belong to early human ancestors associated with the first Australians. The age of the artwork was established through the analysis of mineral crusts that overlay the art. This remarkable finding, emphasized by archaeologist Adam Brumm, challenges previous limitations in the dating of rock art (NBC News).



U.S. speedskating star Jordan Stolz begins quest for four gold medals with an Olympic record

Speedskater Jordan Stolz secured his first Olympic gold medal in the 1,000-meter event, establishing a new Olympic record with a time of 1:06.28, nearly a second faster than the previous record. He outperformed Jennings de Boo from the Netherlands, who took the silver medal, and Zhongyan Ning from China, who claimed bronze. Having competed in the 2022 Winter Olympics at the age of 17, Stolz has since asserted his dominance in the sport, winning the 500-meter, 1,000-meter, and 1,500-meter events at the world championships in both 2023 and 2024. Additionally, he holds the world record in the 1,000-meter with a time of 1:05.37, achieved in January 2024. He emphasized that his Olympic performance was particularly significant due to the differences in altitude (NBC News).



Scientists have revealed the climate shock that profoundly transformed Easter Island.

New research from the Lamont-Doherty Earth Observatory reveals that a prolonged drought began reshaping life on Rapa Nui (Easter Island) around 1550. Scientists extracted sediment cores from freshwater sites to analyze past environmental conditions. By examining hydrogen isotopes in plant waxes, they reconstructed 800 years of rainfall patterns, finding a significant drop in rainfall in the mid-16th century that persisted for over a century. Rather than indicating societal collapse, the research suggests that Rapanui communities adapted and thrived despite severe climate challenges. Lead author Redmond Stein highlighted the importance of understanding this hidden climate history for insights into the environment-culture relationship. (Source: Science Daily)



Exciting Start to Men's Round-Robin Curling as Britain Excels and Tense Matches Occur

Curling continued with the highly anticipated start of the men's round-robin stage, featuring an exciting day with four matches played simultaneously. The atmosphere was electric as fans watched the teams battle it out on the ice. Britain stood out, delivering an impressive performance, beating China 9-4. The other three matches were nail-biters, each ending with just a 1-point difference. Team USA edged past Czechia 8-7, Canada narrowly defeated Germany 7-6, and Italy secured a win against Sweden, also 7-6. As the tournament progresses, the second set of round-robin matches is scheduled for tomorrow and will continue into next week, promising more thrilling moments. Fans and players eagerly anticipate the upcoming games as each team vies for a spot in the finals. (Source: NBC News)



Snowball Earth was not completely frozen, new study reveals

Even when Earth was locked in its most extreme deep freeze, the planet's climate may not have been as silent and still as once believed. New research from ancient Scottish rocks reveals that during Snowball Earth — when ice sheets reached the tropics and the planet resembled a giant snowball from space — climate rhythms similar to today's seasons, solar cycles, and even El Niño-like patterns were still pulsing beneath the ice. The discovery is based on exceptionally well preserved layered rocks called varves on the Garvellach Islands off Scotland's west coast. These sediments formed during the Sturtian glaciation, the most intense Snowball Earth episode, which lasted about 57 million years.

Thomas Gernon, Professor of Earth and Planetary Science at Southampton and a co author of the study, said: "These rocks preserve the full suite of climate rhythms we know from today -- annual seasons, solar cycles, and interannual oscillations -- all operating during a Snowball Earth. That's jaw dropping. It tells us the climate system has an innate tendency to oscillate, even under extreme conditions, if given the slightest opportunity."



Olympic Leaderboard Rankings

Medal winner		1	2	3	
1	 Norway	11	6	7	24
2	 Italy	8	4	10	22
3	 United States	5	8	4	17
4	 Sweden	5	5	1	11
5	 France	4	7	4	15
6	 Austria	4	6	3	13
7	 Germany	4	5	4	13
8	 Netherlands	4	4	1	9
9	 Switzerland	4	2	3	9
10	 Japan	3	5	8	16

As of today

7	1	6	3		9	5		
			6		5			
	9		7			4		3
	2	8		7	3	1		
4		9		5		3	2	6
1	5		2		6		4	8
9	6	2			4		1	
			8		7	6	3	9
3	8				1		5	4

Valentine's Day strawberry fudge

Indulge in the sweet romance of Valentine's Day with our delightful strawberry fudge recipe. This charming treat combines the luscious flavor of strawberries with the creamy richness of fudge to create a mouthwatering experience. Perfect for sharing with your loved one or gifting to friends, this easy-to-make confection is sure to add a touch of sweetness to your celebration. Get ready to whip up a batch of love in every bite!

- (16 ounces) white chocolate
- 1(14-ounce) can sweetened condensed milk
- (3 tablespoons) butter
- (1/2 teaspoon) vanilla
- (2 teaspoons) strawberry Jell-O powder
- Kosher salt
- 1(1-ounce) package of freeze-dried strawberries

1. Line an 8-inch square baking pan with parchment paper.
2. Combine the chocolate, condensed milk, butter, vanilla Jell-O powder, and a pinch of salt in a medium saucepan over low heat, stirring frequently until the mixture is smooth.
3. Set aside 1/4 cup of the strawberries. Crush the remaining strawberries, then fold them into the mixture. Pour the mixture into the prepared pan, smooth the top, and press the reserved strawberries on top, breaking them into bits.
4. Transfer the fudge to the refrigerator and chill until set, about one hour. To serve, remove the candy from the parchment and cut it into 1-inch to 2-inch pieces. Makes about three dozen pieces.

